ATTENTION!

DON’T LET THE STING DIE!

Every year, Rochester students receive a class T-shirt featuring their graduation year on the back. It may seem like a small giveaway, but it creates a visible connection between students who from varying backgrounds.

UR should preserve this tradition, even when facing budget cuts and pressure to redirect spending toward other priorities. The most obvious economic cost is designing, producing, purchasing, and distributing the shirts. The university also commits staff time and resources to organizing the giveaway. Some shirts may go unused, making part of that spending wasteful. The university bears these direct costs, although the exact funding source is unknown.

But the benefits extend beyond the price of a T-shirt. Wearing the same shirt strengthens community and creates a tradition that students can carry with them after graduation. It gives students a small but tangible reason to feel part of Rochester. Of course, saving a tradition can only be worth so much. **How much is a shared sense of belonging worth, and what are we willing to spend to preserve it in lieu of budget cuts to student life and technology?**

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